

with older systems. However, if your requirements aren't met by the 16-bit range, feel free to use the whole spectrum.

The super user or **root**, will by definition always possess UID 0. You will also notice if you open the list of users on your system that there are user accounts created for daemons etc, ensure your manually set UID if any doesn't clash with them.

### GID or Group Identification Number

This is very similar to the UID. We will just enumerate the reserved GIDs: **GID 0** is reserved for **root**, while **GID 1** is reserved for **bin** and the **daemon** group takes **GID 2**. The group listing and other details can be found in the `/etc/group` file.

### GECOS field

Think of it as the address book detail field, there are no fixed formats for this, and varies from system to system. The next two fields will turn out to be of more importance.

### Home directory

It can be an important consideration to decide as to where to locate the home directory, especially in a networked environment, where your users might log on from multiple machines acting as thin clients, if your home directories are mounted over the network, and are unavailable in the event of a server crash.

### Login shell

The login shell is normally a command interpreter such as the Bourne shell or the C shell (`/bin/sh` or `/bin/csh`), but it can be any program. Bash is the default and is used if `/etc/passwd` does not specify a login shell. Most users would be satisfied by this and if they want to make switch, you can always offer the alternative of the slightly more advanced Korn Shell, referred to as the **ksh**.

## 1.2 Adding and deleting users

The process for managing local users and groups is very straight forward and differs very little from most GNU/Linux operating systems. Ubuntu and other Debian based distributions, use "adduser" package for account management.

To add a user account, use the following command syntax, and follow the prompt to give the account a password and other identifiable characteristics:

```
sudo adduser username
```

To delete a user account and its primary group, use the following command